

DON FOURNIER

Director of DevOps

Cloud & Platform Engineering · Enterprise Integration · Application Development · Security

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SUMMARY

Director-level DevOps and platform-engineering leader who advanced from Senior Systems Administrator to department leadership in ~18 months while personally architecting and shipping production systems end-to-end. Track record across multi-system enterprise integration, cloud modernization (AWS + Azure), Kubernetes, AI/LLM platforms, and distributed (follow-the-sun) team leadership. As comfortable commanding a live production incident as authoring the operating model the team runs on — pairing deep hands-on engineering with org-level strategy, hiring, and vendor governance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Cloud: AWS (EKS, EC2, RDS, CloudWatch, IAM, Secrets Manager, CodeBuild, VPC, S3, Cognito, SES), Azure (App Service, Functions, Service Bus, Key Vault, Entra ID)

DevOps / IaC: Terraform, Bicep, Docker, Kubernetes (kubect!, Kustomize, ArgoCD), CI/CD (Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, CodeBuild→ECR), observability/alerting, secrets management, FinOps

Languages: C#/.NET 8, Python, TypeScript/Node.js, SQL (T-SQL)

Integration & Data: Dynamics 365 F&O, OData, event-driven architecture / Service Bus, idempotency & distributed-systems design, ERP ↔ e-commerce ↔ WMS, PostgreSQL/SQL Server, ETL & data remediation

AI / Platform: LLM inference & agent orchestration, multi-model routing, Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers, RAG, Microsoft Graph automation

Leadership: org design & hiring, vendor/MSA governance, incident command, executive reporting, distributed (follow-the-sun) teams, compliance awareness (PCI-DSS / HIPAA / SOC 2)

EXPERIENCE

Mercola Health Systems

Cape Coral, FL → Remote

Director of DevOps & Application Development · Dec 2025 – Present

Manager of DevOps (Aug–Dec 2025) · Manager of Infrastructure & Business Continuity (Apr–Aug 2025) · Infrastructure Consultant, via Oxford Consulting (Jan–Apr 2025)

Advanced from contract consultant to department leadership in under a year; scope now spans applications, architecture, cloud, and security for a high-volume e-commerce health & wellness business.

Integration & Architecture

- Architected and shipped a custom **.NET/Azure middleware integrating three disparate enterprise systems** (legacy order DB, Dynamics 365 ERP, third-party WMS) **from dev to production in 3 weeks**, replacing a retiring legacy connector with zero ERP downtime.
- Reconciled a **multi-million-dollar revenue-recognition discrepancy** and cleared multi-hundred-order integration backlogs; restored a failed cross-system pipeline by root-causing **four chained failures** across SQL Server, Windows services, and Azure Service Bus in a single session. Delivered with ~525 automated tests.
- Designed a secure **multi-operator AI workbench** reference architecture (Zero Trust + SSO/MFA edge, per-operator data isolation, OAuth2 lifecycle), scaling from POC to dozens of operators while eliminating credential-sprawl risk.

Cloud & DevOps

- Authored the enterprise **TCO/feasibility analysis** that drove an e-commerce cloud-modernization decision — ~70% lower maintenance cost, 3–5x lower capital spend, 24-month → ~6-month timeline.
- Architected a **tier-gated PWA platform on EKS** (NestJS/gRPC + Terraform + CloudWatch), cutting revenue-loss detection from manual checks to **<60 seconds**.
- Built a standardized **CI/CD pipeline across 6 microservices** achieving **~10-minute commit-to-live** deploys with pre-deploy validation gates and automated rollback, eliminating deploy-corruption incidents.
- Architected a cost-optimized, isolated **AWS data-science environment** (Terraform, GPU sizing, pgvector RDS, auto-stop scheduling) cutting run cost **~50%**.

AI / Automation Platforms

- Designed and deployed a private **three-tier AI inference + agent control plane** (bulk / premium / local) over a zero-trust mesh, removing a ToS-compliance risk and enabling **500+ tok/s** autonomous agent workflows with an approval-queue safety net.
- Shipped (in ~5 days) an end-to-end **LLM newsletter platform** — nightly content generation → personalized presend → SES delivery at **50K+/day** — replacing a costly legacy enterprise campaign tool.
- Built an automated **executive-metrics pipeline & dashboard** (Python/FastAPI/PostgreSQL/React) and a suite of **MCP servers** (M365 automation, cross-model consensus, ACL-gated remote corpus access) extending the team's AI coding agents.

E-Commerce & Data

- Led a **replatform/migration of 1M+ customer records** across three integrated systems to a modern cloud storefront — zero-downtime cutover, near-perfect data integrity, multiple daily production builds with zero rollbacks.
- Designed an audit-trail-first **data-remediation program** for a 14-year legacy dataset and **built/hired a standing 3-person remediation team**.

Security & Leadership

- Led end-to-end response to a **security incident** — coordinated remediation, external parties, and evidence preservation with **zero customer-facing downtime** — and authored the reusable response runbook.
- Audited security across **~59 repositories**, surfaced critical hardcoded-credential findings, and authored a secrets-management migration roadmap.
- Authored the **DevOps operating model & operations playbook** for a ~20+ person, 3-geography org (follow-the-sun coverage/handoffs, multi-account AWS standards, P1/P2/P3 incident process, defined SLAs/KPIs); designed the org structure, phased hiring roadmap, and a 3-week onboarding curriculum.
- Led **vendor evaluation & MSA negotiation** for a platform-modernization engagement (discovery + 30+ item risk analysis), steering to milestone-based contracting gated on validated scope to prevent cost overruns.
- Reduced AWS spend by **~\$300K/year** through right-sizing and FinOps governance; established a **weekly executive reporting cadence** consolidating 10–20+ contributors across 3 geographies.

Structure Medical LLC

Naples, FL · Jun 2023 – Nov 2024

Senior Systems Administrator

- Designed and implemented enterprise network infrastructure (switches, routers, firewalls) supporting business growth; administered VMware virtualization and Windows Server.
- Reduced system downtime through proactive monitoring (SolarWinds, Wireshark); partnered with Security to deploy firewalls/IPS, decreasing external threat exposure ~40%.

Fischer Identity

Naples, FL · Feb 2022 – May 2023

Managed Service Provider Engineer

- Administered Active Directory and access policies under least-privilege and compliance requirements; implemented identity-management/SSO workflows.
- Supported Azure and AWS cloud-networking integrations for managed-service clients.

Linn-Benton Community College

Albany, OR · Mar 2019 – Feb 2022

IT Support Specialist

- Resolved campus-wide connectivity incidents and maintained wireless network infrastructure.
- Enabled secure remote access for hybrid operations during the COVID-19 transition.

United States Navy

Oct 2003 – May 2018

Information Technology Specialist

- Delivered Tier 1/2 network and communications support across multiple duty stations over a 15-year career in mission-critical environments.
- Maintained network security and documented SOPs that accelerated troubleshooting and onboarding; received multiple commendations for technical excellence.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Networking & Security: Routing & switching, load balancing, firewalls (Fortinet, Palo Alto), IPS/IDS, VPN, DNS, Active Directory, SSO/MFA, zero-trust (Tailscale, Cloudflare), OAuth2/PKI, Nessus, Qualys, AWS WAF

OS & Virtualization: Linux (RHEL), Windows Server, VMware

Observability & Monitoring: CloudWatch, Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog, Sentry, OpenTelemetry, SolarWinds, Wireshark

CI/CD & Containers: Jenkins, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Docker, Kubernetes, Kustomize, ArgoCD, Helm, CodeBuild/ECR

Data Stores: PostgreSQL/pgvector, SQL Server, Redis, MongoDB, Qdrant

Scripting: Python, Bash, PowerShell, TypeScript/Node.js

EDUCATION

- **United States Navy Technical Training** — Information Technology & Network Administration
- **Continuing Professional Development** — Full-Stack Development (React, NestJS, TypeScript), Cloud Architecture, DevOps Engineering, AI/ML Systems

CERTIFICATIONS

- ITIL Foundations
- AWS Solutions Architecture (self-study)